Fortnightly cetuximab + irinotecan

NCCP 00331 · Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending

PRACTICAL TREATMENT GUIDE

Infusion visits and care between treatments

Cetuximab on Day 1. Irinotecan is given on Day 1; no home fluorouracil pump. A repeating 14-day cycle. The number of cycles depends on benefit, side effects and your treatment plan.

STEP 1

Before treatment

Confirm tests, medicines and the exact schedule.

STEP 2

Prepare for the visit

Arrange transport if premedicines or symptoms affect driving.

STEP 3

At the day ward

Blood results, symptoms and venous access are checked.

STEP 4

Infusion and observation

Weekly cetuximab: first infusion about two hours, later doses often one hour. Fortnightly cetuximab: about two hours. Premedicines, review and observation add time. Irinotecan usually runs over 90 minutes.

STEP 5

At home

Follow the skin-care and/or bowel plan. There is no pump to disconnect.

STEP 6

Next review

Confirm the next appointment and follow-up tests.

▼ Do I need a port?

A peripheral cannula or existing central line may be used. A port is not automatically needed; the team considers your veins and overall treatment plan.

▼ If the schedule changes

Ask the unit to confirm the next visit and which medicine is being changed. Do not copy dates from another regimen.

Sources: NCCP 00331 v7: official regimen. Draft — independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending.